

insight ■ tips and tricks

INCREASING PRODUCTIVITY

Manage multiple images and avoid repetitive tasks through simple actions

Gamma correction

Often what you see on screen does not match what you get in print. The gamma correction setting calibrates your monitor so that it remains in synchronisation with your printer and your scanner. Under **Windows > Settings > Control Panel**, select the option Adobe Gamma and the wizard will guide you further. Choose the step-by-step wizard option and then proceed accordingly.

Changing scratch disk

Scratch disk refers to the location on your hard disk where the data is stored while you are working in Photoshop. This will be a lifesaver when you are running out of disk space in the current drive. Go to **Edit > Preferences > Plug-Ins & Scratch disks** and under First,



The scratch disk dialog box

fill in the path where you would primarily want all your data. Under Second, Third and Fourth, fill accordingly.

Working with multiple images

The Tile feature allows you to view a number of images

together and edit them. To tile the images, open all the images you require and then select **Window > Documents > Tile** from the menu in Photoshop 7 (**Windows > Tile** in



Working with multiple images is easy

Photoshop 6). The images get arranged in tile format—you can toggle between them using [Ctrl] + [Tab] and edit the images.

Managing your images (Photoshop 7)

Within the File Browser menu, you can open, select, name, rotate and view images. You can even manage your files and folders—create, rename or delete them. You can rename multiple files using the Batch Rename feature or even rotate one or multiple images with the Rotate feature.

The File Browser displays four panes: Tree, Preview, Metadata and Thumbnail.

Tree pane: The Tree pane shows the files, folders and drives of your system, making it easy to navigate and locate images.

Preview pane: In the Preview pane, you can view a larger image of the selected thumbnail.

Metadata pane: The Metadata pane provides the user with detailed information about the current selection such as the image filename, date when created, image format, along with any additional information entered in the File Info dialog box. It even displays EXIF (Exchangeable Image File) data (that is, information about images created with a digital camera), if it's available.

Thumbnail pane: The Thumbnail pane displays thumbnails by size, rank and text detail. They can be viewed with different

size options such as Small, Medium, Large, Large Rank and Detail. The Large with Rank displays a large thumbnail along with the image's rank while Detail provides information about each image shown such as file name, date created, modified, copyright, format, colour mode, image size (in pixels), file size, rank.

The Rank By and Sort menus help to create a hierarchy for your images, such as proof or final, and sort images according to the stage of completion.

The File Browser lets you sort images by file name, file width and height, size, file type, resolution, colour profile, date created, date modified, and colour.

Actions Speak Louder than Click

Here's how you can use the Actions feature to save time and effort:

- To open and save multiple files of the same size, resolution and mode in one step.
- If there is a folder of images that you need to convert to Web graphics and if the images are somewhat similar, then don't do it individually—choose Actions.
- If you downloaded an action from the Web but Photoshop doesn't seem to recognise it, then first make sure that the action has the file extension .atn. Then go to the Actions palette and from the drop down menu, choose

Load Actions. Now locate your action and click OK. The action will now appear in the Actions palette under its own section from where you can run it.

- When you create actions Photoshop runs them so quickly that you would generally not be able to track a missing or wrong step. To slow down or even put a pause between each step, choose to play your action Step by Step in the Playback Options dialog box in the Actions palette's drop down menu. As an alternative, enter the number of seconds for which you'd like it to pause